

MANY MORE SUPERCOMPS

More power To NASA

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) is all set to get a massive supercomputing boost soon with Project Columbia. This project is part of the plan to get its shuttle missions back in action after the tragic crash of the Columbia in 2003 that killed seven astronauts, including India-born Kalpana Chawla. It is touted to bolster NASA's

computing power ten-fold. The new supercomputer



will be one of the world's biggest Linux-based

The system will have 500 TB of storage, and will use the power of 10,240 Itanium 2 processors

supercomputers, and will help NASA with flight missions, analyses of weather patterns, climate research, and aerospace engineering. The system will have 500 terabytes of storage, and will

use the power of 10,240 Intel Itanium 2 processors!

Interestingly, the supercomputer will be used to model the human impact on climatic changes and global warming.

"The more computer power you have, you can do two things: you can simulate more events, have that many more 'what if scenarios' to foresee other circumstances," Richard Dracott from Intel's Enterprise Platforms Group told BBC News Online.

Climate and weather patterns critical for shuttle missions can be simulated, merged and stored graphically. They can also be modelled over a period of weeks or even months, instead of over just a few days.

VIRUS CREATOR'S TRIAL

Script Kiddie Pleads Guilty

Jeffrey Lee Parson, the unleasher of the Blaster-B variant of the Blaster worm last August, pled guilty on August 11. Parson is a 19-year-old living in Minnesota.

Parson is not the author of the original Blaster worm, which infected one million computers last summer, according to a report in the Seattle times. What Parson did was create a variant of the worm, called Blaster-B, by modifying the original Blaster. He unleashed the worm onto the Net in early August of 2003. Blaster-B would launch a distributed DoS attack against one of Microsoft's Windows Update Web sites from infected computers.

So how was Parson caught? Blaster and its variants are worms that spread by exploiting a well-known vulnerability in Windows. Blaster-B is functionally equivalent to the original Blaster, but creates a file called 'teekids.exe' in the Windows system folder. The original Blaster created a file called 'msblast.exe.' Parson's online nickname, or handle, was 'teekid' or 't33kid.' This, and other



Security Watch

MyDoom

Also Known as W32/Mydoom.o@MM, W32/MyDoom-O, WORM_MYDOOM.M, Win32.Mydoom.O

Infection Method This worm uses its own SMTP engine to send e-mails. It searches the victim's computer as well as Altavista, Google, Lycos and Yahoo for e-mail IDs. For example, if it finds 'something@rediff.com' on your PC, it uses a search engine to procure e-mail IDs ending with rediff.com. The mail's subject, text and attachment vary and the sender is spoofed. It also drops the Trojan Backdoor.Zincite.A, which allows unauthorised remote access to the infected computer.

Damages Degrades system performance, and may clog mail servers as well as networks. Hackers can download and execute files on the affected system.

Removal Instructions: Download the removal tool from <http://security.response.symantec.com/avcenter/FxMydoom.exe>, close all programs, disconnect the PC from the network, disable system restore, and run the tool. You may need to enable Active Desktop after this.

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HOT

Windows XP SP 2

Bundles security revisions and a new update. Important features: Windows Security Centre, auto-triggering Windows Firewall and browsing enhancements for IE.



Windows XP SP 2

Some programs just 'stop working'. By default, SP2 enables Windows Firewall. Over 200 programs have compatibility problems. Even MS Office isn't spared.

NOT

One Silly Question What is a USB port?



Universal Serial Bus. It connects any computer to 127 devices.
Avijit Majumdar, Kolkata



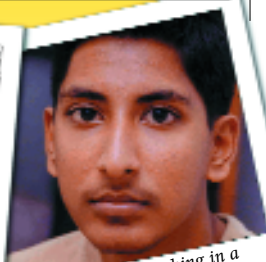
It's Universal something something. Oops, I forgot.
Chintan Shah, Mumbai



Dunno, sounds like some typical gizmo.
Nisha Dhorba, Mumbai



If you let me do a Google search, I can tell you.
Tilak Pokharel, Kathmandu



What is it? Is it something in a computer?
Siddhartha Ganguly, Nagpur